Translator brief: the city laments (the Lament for Ur, the Curse of Agade), 2026-10-19

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A common brief for the sequential translators of `הקינה-על-אור-1/` (ETCSL 2.2.2) and `קללת-אכד-2/` (ETCSL 2.1.5). Reusable for any later Sumerian lament. Adapted from `../סיפורי-הבריאה-המסופוטמיים/translator-brief--sumerian.md`. The coordinator's per-run prompt says which lines are yours.

0. Read first (binding, in this order)

1. `../translation-guidelines.md` — whole. Especially §1 (**two purposes**: the Bible comparison *and* "the soul of the ancients"), §5 (workflow and the lessons), §6 (principles; echo control §6.4; false friends §6.7), §6.8 (brackets), §7.2 (the annotated format).
2. `corpus.md`, then `renderings.md` (**all of it is binding**; §3 fixes the refrains, §5 the reserved strings).
3. The creation corpus's Sumerian renderings (`../סיפורי-הבריאה-המסופוטמיים/renderings.md` §5–§8) – they are the default for every word not in our file; and skim `../סיפורי-הבריאה-המסופוטמיים/4-אנקי-וסדר-העולם/annotated-1.rtl.md` (a model for the format and the depth of the apparatus).
4. Your project's `project.md` and `renderings.md`, and **the Hebrew of every earlier run** (`python3 -I lament_tools.py grep all '<regex>'`). Read the previous files of your own project in full before you start.

1. Rules learned the hard way (put them first)

- **Draft unvocalized, in plene spelling (כתיב מלא), from the very first line.** Vocalize only names at their first occurrence, ambiguous words, and the names that are always vocalized (★ in renderings §1: Urim אוּר, Sumer שׁוּמֶר, An אַן, Inana אִינַנָּה, Utu אוּתוּ, Umma אוּמָה, Bau בָּאוּ, Keš כֶּשׁ, Šara שַׁרָא, Ezina דָּגָן, *me* הַ־מָה). Never strip niqqud with a naive regex (it deletes the maqaf): keep [redacted]. Three earlier translators drafted vocalized and had to rewrite everything.

- **Translate the Sumerian, not ETCSL's English.** Form your reading from the transliteration, ETCSL's TEI lemmas, the ORACC lemma + morph (`../sources/ORACC/epsd2-literary--Q000379--Lament-for-Ur/Q000379--lemmatised-morph.md`, `...--Q000375--Curse-of-Agade/Q000375--lemmatised-morph.md`; same line labels; the Agade Ur III segments as "Ver.2, Seg.X, N") and ePSD2; read ETCSL's translation (rank 3) only afterwards and record every disagreement. ETCSL's English has repeatedly imported biblical language in this programme ("not yet", "cursed", "created", "firmament"); here watch for "righteous" (*zid*), "exile", "glory", "abandon", "daughter", "lament" – check each against the Sumerian.
- **The verbal chain.** In the **פירוק** bullet parse every finite verb: prefix chain (modal *ḫe₂-* / *ḫa-* / *ḫu-*, *ga-*, *u₃-*, *nu-*, *na-*, *ba-ra-* "not"; conjugation prefix *mu-*, *i₃-*, *ba-*, *bi₂-*, *im-ma-*, *am₃-*; dimensional infixes *-na-*, *-da-*, *-ta-*, *-ši-*, *-ni-*; agent *-n-*/*-b-*), the base (ḫamṭu or marû, reduplication) and suffixes (*-e*, *-eš*, *-ene*, nominaliser *-a*, *-am₃*). Say where the morph comes from (ORACC, or `../tools/sumerian_workbench.py morph`, or **"ניתוח שלנו"**). **Name every Emesal form and its main-dialect equivalent** (renderings §2).
- **Sumerian → Hebrew grammar** (creation corpus): narrative marû = participle; ḫamṭu = past; *ḫe₂-* = jussive/wish – **but in the Lament for Ur *ḫe₂-* with ḫamṭu in a narrative is often affirmative ("indeed ...")**: decide by context and say so; *ga-* = cohortative; *u₃-* = "after/when"; non-finite *-a* = relative clause or infinitive; *nu-* = לֹא (never טֶרֶם); *ba-ra-* = emphatic negation לֹא (לֹא ... כְּלָל only if needed); copula *-am₃* = nominal sentence.
- **One line = one Hebrew line**, with ETCSL's label. The *kirugu* and *ĝišgiĝal* rubric lines are lines: translate them (הַגִּישְׁגִּיגַל שָׁלוֹ , קִירוּגוּ רִאשׁוֹן. – renderings §4). Keep the break, the order of images, the parallelism and **every repetition: identical Sumerian → identical Hebrew** (the refrains are fixed in renderings §3 and checked by script; `verify` lists the rest).
- **Brackets**: a word whose root is broken in the composite is in `[]`; `[...]` for a lost stretch; `...` for a word ETCSL leaves untranslated or an `X`; `()` added for sense; `?` uncertain reading; **נטוי** uncertain translation; `⟨⟩` scribal omission. ETCSL manuscript variants ("1 ms. has instead/adds") go in the apparatus, with their Hebrew when they change the sense. The pluses of some manuscripts (18A, 100A, 209A, 432A, 87A, 87B, 93A, 11A) are entries of their own.
- **Reserved and gated strings** (renderings §5) are checked by script; the run fails if one slips in. Before you choose a word that the Bible comparison needs (נטש, עזב, ארר, קלל, שוב, תל, נכרי, אויב, מר, אנחה, עד מתי, אוי, הוי, דמעה), check that the Sumerian word is the one the renderings assign to it. **Tag every such word in the apparatus.**
- **Bible quotations** in the apparatus: vocalized, in backticks, followed by the reference in the repository's format (`(איכה א:א)`), copied from `../../../תנך-מנוקד/` (`python3 -I ../tools/check_bible_quotes.py --show "איכה א"` prints a verse) and verified with `python3 -I ../tools/check_bible_quotes.py <file>`. The Hebrew Bible's chapter and verse numbering (e.g. Jer 31:14, not 31:15). Fix every mismatch. Keep the `-` of Psalms and Proverbs.

2. The annotated file (guidelines §7.2)

Header (Hebrew): title `# … – תרגום מוער (חלק N: שורות X–Y)`; then paragraphs **נוסח הבסיס**, **פירוק** (where the lemmas and morph come from), **אמסל** (what Emesal is, how this file treats it: renderings §2), **תגי הקבלה**, **תרגומים להשוואה**, **סימנים**, **מספור**, a paragraph that explains the text on its own terms (first file of each project: what a city lament is and how it was used; the *kirugu* / *ĝišgiĝal* form; the fall of Ur III / Akkad and the Gutians; later files: the part of the story you translate), **שמות**, **מלים שמורות**. Then `---`, then sections `## <from>–<to>: <Hebrew heading>` (the clean translation takes its headings from these; one section per *kirugu* + its *ĝišgiĝal* in the Lament for Ur, by content in Agade), then one entry per ETCSL line:

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### 81
`e-ne-ra nam uru₂-na mu-na-te er₂ gig i₃-še₈-še₈`
> דמעות מרות היא בוכה — לְמַעַן עִירוֹ נִיגְשָׁה אֵלָיו.
- **פירוק:** … (every word; the verbal chain; Emesal forms; the source of the mo
- **תרגומים:** ETCSL: "…" — agreement / disagreement and why. (Kramer 1940, if y
- **הקבלה:** [equivalent] `(איכה א:ב) בָּכוֹ תִבְכֶּה בַּלָּיְלָה וְדִמְעָתָהּ עַל לֶחֱיָהּ` — … (only r
- **הערות:** the line on its own terms: the image, the realia, the ritual, the t
- **הערת שוליים:** (optional) one sentence that the clean translation should car
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- The transliteration line is copied **exactly** from ETCSL's `transliteration.md` (the text after the label, including ETCSL's `...` catalogue notes and variant parentheses, or without them – the script ignores both, but nothing else may differ). `python3 -I lament_tools.py lines KEY FROM-TO` prints your lines.
- For the Agade Ur III segments use the labels `A1` … `F7` and one section per segment (`## קטע A (נוסח אור השלישית)`).
- **`הערות` matters as much as `הקבלה`** (guidelines §1): a city and its god; the goddess's plea; the gods' assembly; the irrevocable word; the storm as Enlil's decision; Emesal and the *gala*; how the laments were performed; the herds and the dairy, the canals, the festivals and dances, the granaries, the debt-prison, the nursemaids; the Elamites, Šimaški and the Gutians; Agade's trade with Meluḫḫa and Dilmun; omens, dreams and extispicy; temple building and why it needs the god's consent; what made a king's act sacrilege. Not every line needs a note; the ones that open the ancient mind do.
- Not every line has a parallel; never force one. **[absent]** and **[divergence]** are findings too (e.g. no sin of the city in the Lament for Ur; no human guilt at all until 1 ms. of the last prayer; in Lamentations the city's sin is the cause).

3. Tools

- `python3 -I ../tools/sumerian_workbench.py lemmas <c.xml> FROM-TO` — ETCSL's TEI lemmas per word; `line <c.xml> FROM-TO` adds ORACC morph for each verb where the same form is parsed elsewhere; `morph '<form>'`; `conc '<regex>' [--lemma]` (ETCSL-wide concordance: formulas recur, e.g. in the other city laments 2.2.3–2.2.6 – look them up before fixing a line); `gloss '<regex>'` (ePSD2 glossary). The XML: `../sources/ETCSL/2.2.2--Lament-for-Ur/c.2.2.2.xml`, `../sources/ETCSL/2.1.5--Curse-of-Agade/c.2.1.5.xml`.
- `python3 -I lament_tools.py verify LU|CA` (coverage, transliteration = ETCSL, one `>` per entry, reserved strings, name traps, refrains, identical lines); `grep all '<regex>'`; `lines`.
- The clean translation is **generated**: the coordinator writes `translation--intro.rtl.md` and runs `lament_tools.py build`. Never write `translation.rtl.md` by hand.

4. Before you finish (each run)

1. Three review passes over your lines (guidelines §5.6: fidelity; consistency with `renderings.md` and the earlier Hebrew; Hebrew read aloud), each a separate read-through; record them in `project.md` ("Progress").
2. `python3 -I lament_tools.py verify <KEY>` clean for your lines (notes about not-yet-drafted files are fine); `python3 -I ../tools/check_bible_quotes.py <your annotated file>` clean.
3. In `project.md`, under your run's heading: the **parallels index** `### Parallels index (<KEY>)` (KEY = LU1, LU2, LU3, CA1, CA2) as a table with exactly the columns `| Line | Sumerian | Hebrew rendering | Bible | Tag | Comment |` (the header row starts with `| Line`; Line = the ETCSL label; Bible = the vocalized verse(s) in backticks followed by the reference); your **key findings** (Bible; and the ancient mind) in a few sentences; your **open decisions** (numbered); and **Proposals for the corpus renderings** (new terms a later run will need, with the Hebrew strings exactly as you used them).
4. Add your text-specific terms to the project's `renderings.md` (table: Sumerian | Hebrew | Tag | Notes | Lines).
5. Do **not** edit the corpus files (`corpus.md`, `renderings.md`, `parallels-index.md`, the tools), the guidelines, or any other project: the coordinator merges. Do not commit.
6. Final message to the coordinator (short): lines done, verify / quote-check status, the strongest findings (Bible, and the ancient mind), open decisions, and any deviation from the corpus renderings (with the reason).